How to *Live with Art.*

A practical guide to discovering artists, finding work you connect with, and becoming a more informed collector and patron.



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Art becomes part of our lives through people.

Find it through a conversation, an artist we meet, a gallery we return to, or a work we cannot stop thinking about.

This guide offers several ways to begin—or go deeper. Meet the people shaping tonight's conversation. Explore the books, platforms, artists, and ideas they recommend. Find places to visit and practical ways to build confidence, ask better questions, and support artists over time.

MEET	Three perspectives on making, interpreting, and living with art.
EXPLORE	Books, platforms, artists, and ideas selected by Kinjil, Sadaf, and Melissa.
VISIT	Exhibitions, galleries, museums, and organizations worth exploring.
BEGIN	Simple ways to look more closely and collect with intention.
SUPPORT	How to sustain artists and the wider arts community beyond a purchase.

SPEAKER / COLLECTOR PERSPECTIVE

Kinjil Mathur

ADVISOR AND BOARD MEMBER

@kinjil



Kinjil Mathur is an active participant in the arts, with a career at the intersection of culture and technology. Most recently, she served as Chief Marketing Officer of Squarespace, where over eight years she built and led the global marketing organization, scaling the company through its IPO and into its next chapter as a public company. Previously, she spent a decade in fashion and retail, helping established brands navigate the transformation to modern commerce.

Today, Kinjil brings her creative thinking and business acumen to the worlds she cares about, including her work with the NYC Public Housing Community Fund and Search for Common Ground, as well as an ambitious project with Sotheby's that brought her deeper into the art world beyond collecting. She and her husband were featured in Artsy's 2022 collector list.

Her work with culture and community has been recognized with honors including Adweek's Visionary of the Year and Top 20 Tech-Savvy CMOs, Forbes' CMO Next, Ad Age's Women to Watch, Business Insider's 27 Most Innovative CMOs, Gold House's Gold100, and Vogue India's 50 Most Influential Global Indians.

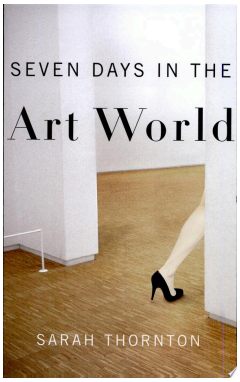
TONIGHT

How taste develops—and how collecting can become a relationship rather than a transaction.

The Bookshelf.

Three books selected by Kinjil Mathur for anyone looking to better understand the art world.

01

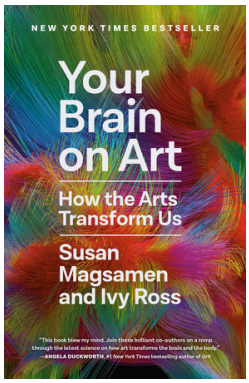


Seven Days in the Art World

BY SARAH THORNTON

The first book I read that pulled back the curtain on the art world and revealed the intricate dance between artists, galleries, collectors, institutions, and the market. It opened my eyes to the forces beneath the surface, and made me see collecting as much as a study of people and power as of art.

02

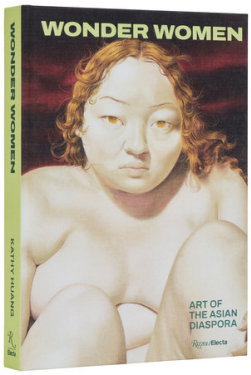


Your Brain on Art

BY SUSAN MAGSAMEN & IVY ROSS

A beautiful reminder that our response to art is not simply intellectual or aesthetic. It lives in the body, in memory, emotion, and even our biology. It made me think differently about why certain works stop us in our tracks, and why art can change the way we experience being alive.

03



Wonder Women: The Art of the Asian Diaspora

BY KATHY HUANG

Part art book, part portal: a wonderfully accessible introduction to a constellation of artists whose work deserves to be known and followed. I was also fortunate to support the making of the book, but what makes it meaningful to me is that it feels like a crash course in discovering artists, stories, and perspectives that might otherwise remain just outside our field of vision.

SPEAKER / CURATORIAL PERSPECTIVE

Sadaf Padder

INDEPENDENT CURATOR, ART ADVISOR, WRITER, AND EDUCATOR

@pitterpadder



Sadaf Padder is an independent curator and art advisor whose work centers artists from the South Asian, African, and other diasporic communities. She has curated exhibitions and programs across the country, from Philadelphia and New York to Los Angeles and Martha's Vineyard, exploring subjects ranging from ecology and material histories to mythology and cultural inheritance.

Through her curatorial and advisory practice, Padder works closely with artists, collectors, galleries, and institutions. She advises emerging and established collectors on building collections grounded in personal connection, research, and sustained engagement with artists, while creating opportunities for artists to enter significant public and private collections. Her curatorial work has contributed to acquisitions by the Baltimore Museum of Art, Northwestern University, the McEvoy Foundation for the Arts, and the RISD Museum, among others.

Her approach is informed by her earlier career as a public school educator and administrator, with an emphasis on access and creating meaningful entry points into contemporary art. Her exhibitions and projects have been featured in *ARTnews*, Artsy, *Hyperallergic*, and *LA Weekly*.

Padder has contributed writing to *Artsy*, *Hyperallergic*, *The Margins*, *Cultured Magazine*, *Visual AIDS*, and *UP Magazine*. She is a Create Change alumna of The Laundromat Project, a featured curator with Artsy, a 2022–23 Emily J. Hall Tremaine Journalism Fellow through *Hyperallergic*, and served as the 2026 Critic-in-Residence at Art Omi. She serves on the boards of the Vera List Center for Art and Politics and Twelve Gates Arts.

TONIGHT

How context deepens looking—and how an advisor can help a collector move with confidence and intention.

The Art Index.

A few resources selected by Sadaf Padder for discovering artists, reading exhibition reviews, and exploring artwork and pricing.

01

Discover artists, explore galleries, and browse available works and pricing.

ARTSY · artsy.net

02

HYPERALLERGIC

Independent arts journalism, exhibition reviews, and cultural commentary.

HYPERALLERGIC · hyperallergic.com

03

PXP CONTEMPORARY

Discover emerging artists and accessible, affordably priced contemporary art.

PXP CONTEMPORARY · pxpcontemporary.com

SPEAKER / ARTIST PERSPECTIVE

Melissa Joseph

NEW YORK-BASED ARTIST

@melissajoseph_art



Melissa Joseph's work considers family histories, materiality, and the politics of how we occupy space. She intentionally alludes to women's labor, her experience as the biracial daughter of an immigrant in rural America, and the cultural mashups of diasporic life. Her practice brings together textile knowledge, accessible materials, archival family photographs, and a painterly approach to needle felting.

Her work has been shown at the Brooklyn Museum, Delaware Contemporary, Woodmere Art Museum, Utah Museum of Contemporary Art, MOCA Arlington, Brattleboro Museum and Art Center, ICA San Francisco, and Rockefeller Center through Art Production Fund. Her work is held in the permanent collections of the Akron Art Museum, Brooklyn Museum, Ruby City, RISD Museum, ICA Miami, and Flint Institute of Arts.

Joseph has participated in residencies including Dora Maar House, Cove Park, Greenwich House Pottery, Artpace, Dieu Donné, the Textile Arts Center, Fountainhead, the Archie Bray Foundation, and the Museum of Arts and Design. She holds an MFA from the Pennsylvania Academy of the Fine Arts, an MAT in Art Education from RISD, an AAS in Textile Surface Design from FIT, and a BA from NYU.

Joseph received the Brooklyn Museum's 2025 UOVO Prize and is a 2026 NYFA/NYSCA Fellow in Craft/Sculpture. She is also a regular contributor to BOMB Magazine.



ARTWORK BY MELISSA JOSEPH

647 Evergreen

See more work in *Casserole Culture* at Charles Moffett through October 17.

The Watchlist.

Three artists, exhibitions, or ideas selected by Melissa Joseph to discover next.

01



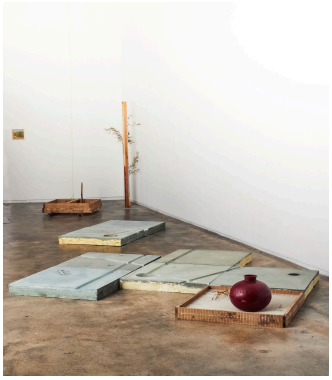
Kiran Joan

GUARDIAN, 2025

Kiran is an incredible sculptor, designer, and educator. Her clay figures carry a wonderful sense of presence and living histories that speak directly to the hearts of those who encounter them. Each figure has a corresponding narrative connected to Indian textiles.

EXPLORE · kiranjoan.com

02



Vaishnavi (Vaishu) Ilankamban

CONCRETE IS COOLING UNDER THE FEET, 2025

Vaishu is a master woodcarver who worked for years at the legendary George Nakashima Woodworkers before attending graduate school for fine art. Her practice is rooted in ecological relationships and the power of craft.

EXPLORE · vaishuilankamban.com

03



Anam Rani

INSTALLATION OF MFA THESIS AT HUNTER COLLEGE, 2026

Anam uses materials in a beautiful way to tell stories and reimagine our relationships to everyday objects.

FOLLOW · @abnamrani_92

Start with work you can see.

THROUGH OCT 17

Melissa Joseph: *Casserole Culture*

Fifteen new needle-felted paintings and mixed-media sculptures rooted in family, place, and diasporic life.

CHARLES MOFFETT / 394 BROADWAY, 2ND FLOOR

OCT 1–DEC 5

Other Stories—A Genealogy for the Present

AINA Gallery's opening exhibition in its new Chelsea space, continuing a program centered on modern and contemporary art from South Asia and beyond.

AINA GALLERY / 550 WEST 29TH STREET

ONGOING

Arts of South Asia

Historical context across the region within the Brooklyn Museum's renovated Arts of Asia galleries.

BROOKLYN MUSEUM / 200 EASTERN PARKWAY

PERMANENT COLLECTION

Art of South and Southeast Asia

Use The Met's collection and galleries to follow materials, religious traditions, court cultures, and artistic exchange across centuries. Works rotate.

THE METROPOLITAN MUSEUM OF ART / 1000 FIFTH AVENUE

Places to return to.

Follow these institutions and communities for exhibitions, talks, archives, and new ways to stay engaged with art.

MUSEUM + PROGRAMS

Asia Society Museum

Rotating exhibitions, talks, films, and public programs focused on Asia and its diasporas. See the October calendar for current programs.

725 PARK AVENUE

RESEARCH + TALKS

Asia Art Archive in America

A research organization and program space for contemporary Asian art—not a conventional commercial gallery.

43 CROSBY STREET, 2ND FLOOR

FOUNDATION

The FLAG Art Foundation

Free contemporary exhibitions and public programs. Anoushka Mirchandani's 2026 exhibition is closed, but its archive and artist conversation remain online.

545 WEST 25TH STREET, 9TH FLOOR

COMMUNITY

South Asian Women's Creative Collective

Follow exhibitions, gatherings, and opportunities supporting South Asian women and nonbinary artists.

PROGRAMS VARY / SAWCC.ORG

CALENDAR + COMMUNITY

Asian American Arts Alliance

A useful citywide calendar and community resource spanning visual art, film, performance, and multidisciplinary practice.

PROGRAMS ACROSS NEW YORK / AAARTSALLIANCE.ORG

Galleries to know in New York.

These galleries regularly present South Asian artists, diasporic practices, or significant histories from the region.

Aicon Contemporary

Contemporary painting, sculpture, photography, and installation by artists from India, Pakistan, and the wider South Asian diaspora.

35 Great Jones Street · aiconcontemporary.com

Talwar Gallery

A longstanding program connecting contemporary South Asian artists with landmark modern practices across its New York and New Delhi spaces.

108 East 16th Street · talwargallery.com

DAG

Historical breadth across modern Indian art, from major twentieth-century figures to living artists. Confirm public access before visiting.

1325 Avenue of the Americas · dagworld.com

Sundaram Tagore Gallery

A broader Asian and international program that regularly returns to artists from India and the South Asian diaspora.

542 West 26th Street · sundaramtagore.com

AINA Gallery

Formerly Aicon Art, AINA opens its Chelsea space October 1 with modern and contemporary work from South Asia and beyond.

550 West 29th Street · aicon.art

Galleries beyond New York.

These galleries and art spaces present South Asian artists and diasporic practices in cities across the country.

Rajiv Menon Contemporary

A gallery dedicated to contemporary art from South Asia and its diaspora, with a growing program of exhibitions and public conversations.

Los Angeles · rmcontemporary.com

Gallery Wendi Norris

A cross-cultural contemporary program representing Chitra Ganesh and presenting artists whose work moves between histories, geographies, and disciplines.

San Francisco · gallerywendinorris.com

Hosfelt Gallery

A contemporary gallery representing Kolkata-born artist Rina Banerjee, whose sculpture and painting examine migration, material, and belonging.

San Francisco · hosfeltgallery.com

Ruttkowski;68

Its New York program, directed by Rose Neveling, includes artists Baseera Khan and Joya Mukerjee Logue.

New York · ruttkowski68.com

Twelve Gates Arts

A nonprofit gallery and cultural space amplifying contemporary artists from South Asia, the Middle East, and their diasporas through exhibitions and programs.
Philadelphia · twelvegatesarts.org

South Asia Institute

A Chicago institution devoted to the art and cultures of South Asia and its diasporas, with exhibitions, research, and public programs.
Chicago · saichicago.org

PATRON

A contemporary gallery whose exhibition history includes New Delhi–born artist Kaveri Raina and other materially driven emerging practices.
Chicago · patrongallery.com

Asian Art Museum

Collection galleries and changing exhibitions offer a broad route into South Asian art across centuries, alongside contemporary Asian and diasporic practices.
San Francisco · asianart.org

Seattle Asian Art Museum

Part of Seattle Art Museum, with collection displays and exhibitions that connect historic South Asian art with wider regional and contemporary contexts.
Seattle · seattleartmuseum.org

Living with art starts with looking.

You do not need a fully formed point of view before you begin. Attention comes first; confidence develops through experience.

01	LOOK WIDELY	Visit museums, galleries, fairs, open studios, and artist-run spaces. Notice what you return to.
02	KEEP A RECORD	Save images and note what held you: material, color, subject, scale, story, or feeling.
03	ASK FREELY	Ask about the artist, medium, date, provenance, edition, condition, and gallery relationship.
04	KNOW THE FULL COST	Consider shipping, tax, framing, insurance, installation, and care before committing.
05	BUY WITH INTENTION	Choose work you want to encounter repeatedly—not work you believe you are supposed to like.
06	COMMISSION	Ask how the artist prefers inquiries to be handled, and respect existing gallery and advisory relationships. If an advisor introduced you to an artist, continue the conversation through them.

Culture takes form.

Art does not live only on gallery walls. It moves through design, ritual, play, storytelling, and the objects we create and pass forward.



Mubarak&co

Sana Raheem

FOUNDER · MUBARAK & CO.

Sana Raheem founded Mubarak & Co. with a simple belief: Ramadan deserves to feel as beautiful and thoughtfully designed as any other holiday season. As a Muslim woman and mother, she struggled to find pieces that reflected how her family actually celebrates—modern, intentional, and rooted in tradition.

MUBARAKANDCO.COM



KULTURE KHAZANA

Akruti Babaria

FOUNDER & CULTURAL EDUCATOR · KULTURE KHAZANA

Akruti Babaria founded Kulture Khazana after she could not find toys or books that reflected her South Asian heritage for her son. Its hands-on products celebrate Indian festivals, stories, and traditions in ways that are playful, educational, and made for every family—turning culture into something children can make, imagine, and share.

KULTUREKHAZANA.COM

Together, these founders show how culture stays alive: reinterpreted with care, made tangible, and placed in the hands of the next generation.

OASES.

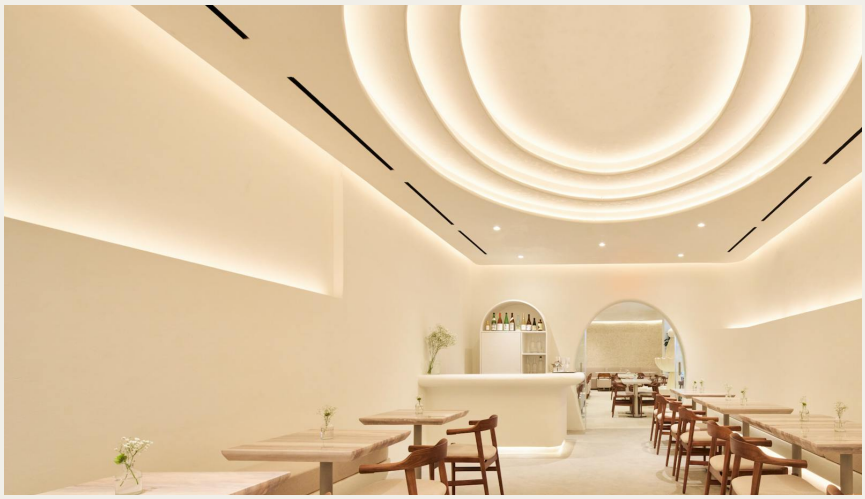
A space shaped around food, ritual, community, and design—the setting for tonight's conversation about how art enters everyday life.

A founder's vision.

Founder Sonam Sangmo draws on her Himalayan and Buddhist upbringing in India, as well as her background in luxury fashion design, to envision and curate each OASES space. Her aim is to evoke the feeling of entering a friend's home—a warm, welcoming environment that promotes balance and rejuvenation.

The space.

Located in the heart of Chelsea, the wellness collective brings together distinct spaces rooted in Ayurvedic principles of balance and harmony. Designed to engage all five senses, OASES is grounded in ethical, mindful, and informed consumption. Tonight, we gather in the intimate Tara Room.





Images: OASES official website.

101D WEST 14TH STREET
NEW YORK, NY 10011

OASESNYC.COM
@OASESNYC

Notes.

Notes.

Take the conversation with you.

What will you look at differently after tonight?

An artist I want to follow

A place or exhibition I want to visit

A question I want to keep asking

One way I can support an artist

ABOUT SALUTE

South Asian leadership starts with *us.*

South Asian Leaders Unite to Empower (SALUTE) is a private, professional network dedicated to creating impactful connections between South Asian women.

OUR MISSION

Our mission is to expand access, visibility, and connection for South Asian women and allies. Our members are executives, trailblazers, and pioneers who are shaping the present and influencing the future.

HOW WE BUILD IT

We curate rooms with intention—bringing together people whose experiences, perspectives, and ambitions can meaningfully intersect. Every gathering includes a Give and an Ask, because meeting is not the outcome; shared action is. Every person arrives prepared to offer what they can—an insight, introduction, resource, or opportunity—and to name the support they need to move forward.

This reciprocal exchange is the connective tissue of SALUTE: leadership infrastructure that helps people be seen, turns connection into access, and opens pathways to opportunity and meaningful advancement.

SALUTE is a registered 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization.

WEBSITE
salute.community

INSTAGRAM
@salute.community

LINKEDIN
linkedin.com/company/salutecommunity

SALUTE